



ARTO

An E-Commerce Mobile Application for Handmade Art

BCA SEMESTER 6 PROJECT

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What is ARTO?

ARTO is a **comprehensive e-commerce mobile platform** purpose-built for the handmade art ecosystem. It bridges the gap between independent creators, local artisans, and art enthusiasts — creating a trusted, organised marketplace where creativity meets commerce.

For Artists

A dedicated space to showcase, manage, and sell original artwork with ease.

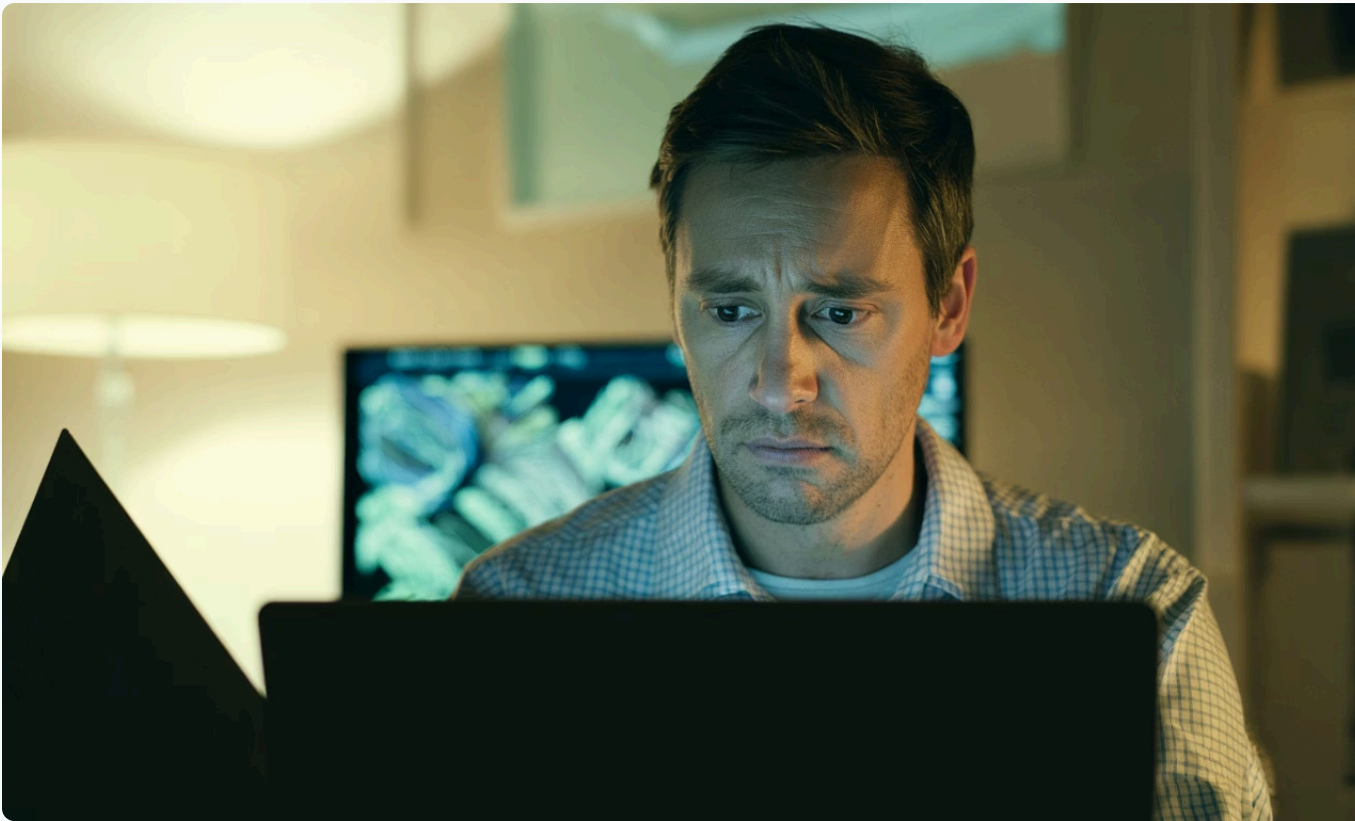
For Buyers

Discover authentic handmade art with secure checkout and real-time tracking.

One Platform

Dual-mode interface seamlessly serving both sellers and buyers.

Problem Statement



The Gap in the Market

Complex Seller Onboarding

Global platforms like **Etsy** impose lengthy registrations and high commission fees, alienating independent and local artists.

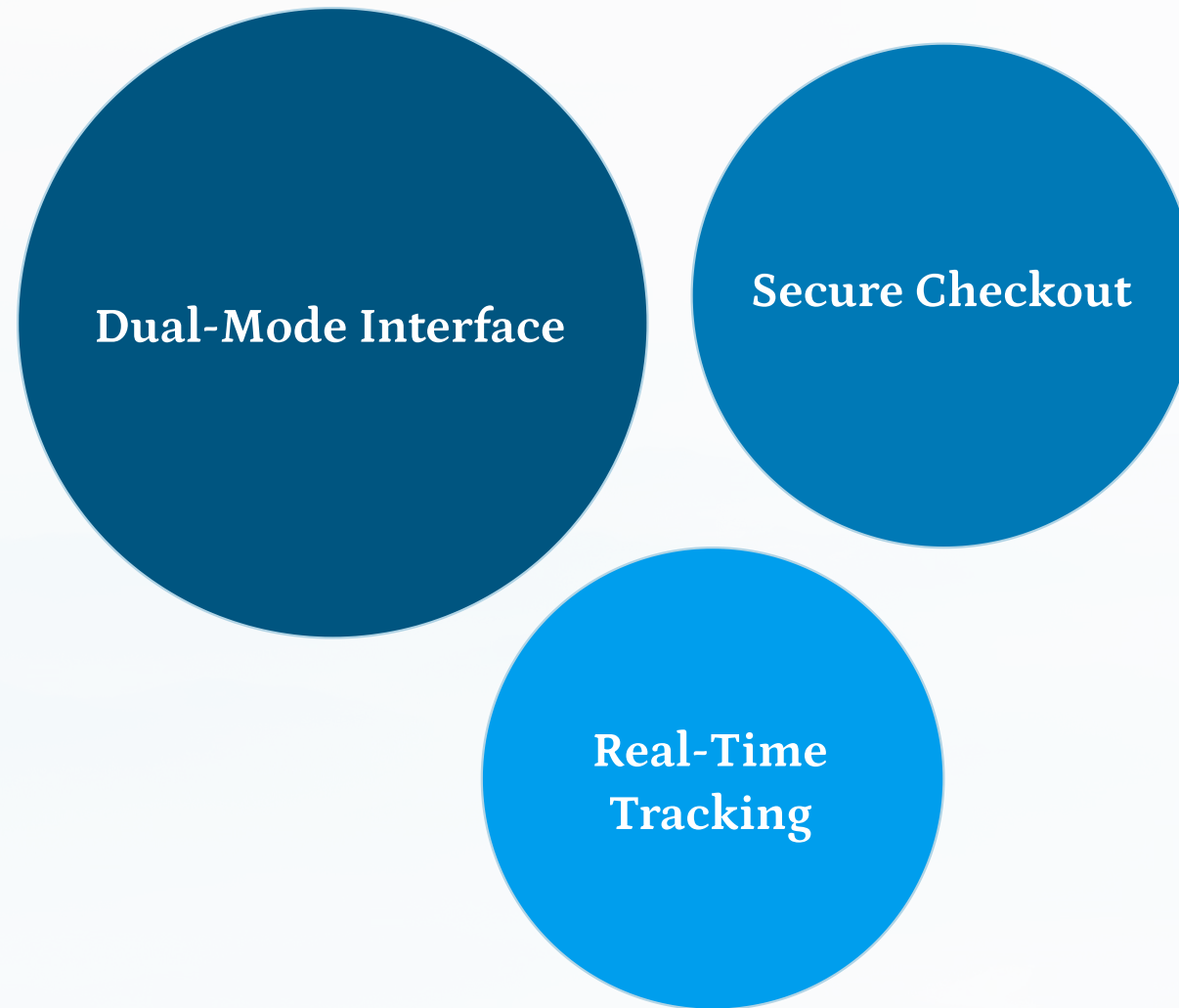
Buyer Trust Deficit

Buyers resort to **Instagram DMs** for purchases — an unstructured, insecure, and unreliable experience.

No Dedicated Art Space

No existing platform combines **art-focused discovery**, simple onboarding, and secure transactions in one place.

Project Objectives



ARTO's design is driven by three core objectives that address every friction point in the current art-buying ecosystem — from discovery to delivery.

Target Audience



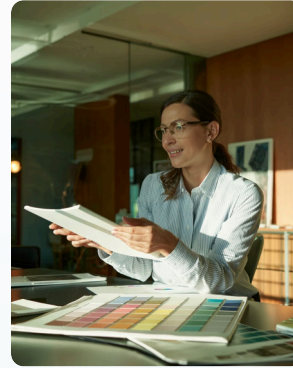
Hobbyist Artists

Casual creators seeking a simple, low-friction way to monetise their passion projects.



Traditional Artisans

Local craftspeople preserving cultural heritage who need a trustworthy digital storefront.



Interior Designers

Professionals sourcing unique, original artwork to complement curated living and work spaces.

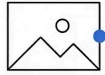


Serious Collectors

Discerning buyers seeking authentic, traceable handmade pieces to grow their collections.

Competitive Analysis

ARTO is designed to outperform existing alternatives by focusing exclusively on the handmade art segment. Unlike generic marketplaces, ARTO keeps the artist and buyer at the centre of every feature decision.

ARTO  Dedicated Art Focus	Etsy  Broad Crafts	Instagram  No Art Focus
 <3 Min Onboarding	 Lengthy Onboarding	 Onboarding N/A
 Secure Checkout	 Secure Checkout	 No Secure Checkout
 Low Commission Fees	 High Commission Fees	 No Commission Fees
 Real-time Order Tracking	 Basic Order Tracking	 No Order Tracking

→ Dedicated Art Focus

Unlike Etsy's broad crafts category, ARTO is built exclusively for visual and handmade art.

→ Onboarding in Under 3 Mins

Streamlined seller setup versus Etsy's lengthy verification and listing process.

→ Secure Checkout

Replaces Instagram's informal DM-based transactions with a trusted payment flow.



User Research Insights

77.8%

Trust as Top Barrier

Majority of surveyed users identified building buyer trust as the single biggest challenge for online art sales.

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Key UX Demands

Simple UI, advanced category filters, and a visual order tracking timeline were the top three user requirements.

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Distinct User Modes

Research confirmed the need for separate, purpose-built experiences for buyers and sellers within a single app.

Core Features



Seller Dashboard

Inventory management, artwork listing, and sales analytics in a single, intuitive panel.



Categorised Discovery

Buyer home screen with organised art categories and advanced filters for effortless browsing.



Seamless Cart & Checkout

Secure, streamlined shopping cart replacing informal DM-based purchase negotiations.



Dual-Profile Switching

Users can instantly toggle between Buyer and Seller modes without logging out or changing accounts.

System Design & UI/UX



Design Philosophy

ARTO's interface was crafted in **Figma** following the **Design Thinking Process** — empathise, define, ideate, prototype, and test — ensuring every screen solves a real user problem.

Colour Palette

Primary Blue & White — clean, trustworthy, and art-forward.

Typography

Modern, legible typefaces ensuring clarity on small mobile screens.

Component System

Reusable UI components for consistent experience across all screens.

Usability Testing & Iterations

Iterative Design Process

Real user feedback was collected across multiple testing rounds. Each round surfaced specific pain points that directly shaped the next design iteration — ensuring ARTO evolved around genuine user behaviour, not assumptions.

- ❏ **Key Improvement:** Horizontal category tabs were added to the home screen after users reported difficulty discovering art by type — significantly improving browsing efficiency.

